

KABIR FAYE

Cloud Solutions Architect | Head of Engineering

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| github.com/Salla21/realworld-cicd-pipeline-project-1

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cloud Solutions Architect and Head of AWS Engineering with 12+ years across DevOps, cloud architecture, networking, and programming. Led multi-million dollar cloud transformations across automotive and retail. Designs and ships generative AI solutions such as multi-agent architectures, RAG pipelines, and AI/ML integrations with enterprise systems. Certified at Professional and Specialty levels across AWS and Aviatrix multicloud networking. Builds and mentors AWS engineering teams across DACH and EMEA.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

Mar 2024 - Present

Professional Services Delivery Engineer | Rackspace Technology

- Led cloud migration of a centralized planning and monitoring platform from on-premises to AWS across ECS Fargate, Route 53, CloudFront, WAF, ALB/NLB, Secrets Manager, S3, KMS, and secure RDS/Aurora access
- Owned CI/CD strategy and infrastructure automation with GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Terraform, Terragrunt, Docker, Amazon ECR, and ECS; deployment velocity rose 30%
- Enforced shift-left security in CI:** gated Terraform validate/plan/apply behind automated scans using Trivy (IaC misconfiguration and secret scanning) and Deepfence (workload/runtime security), with OIDC role assumption for short-lived AWS access and secured private module access
- Delivered the Metis AI platform, an event-driven AWS AI system using Bedrock, Textract, Transcribe, Translate, Comprehend, Cognito, ECS, Lambda, API Gateway, and SNS/SQS
- Managed Aviatrix multicloud networking across AWS and Azure, including ActiveMesh, SmartGroups, Distributed Cloud Firewall, and centralized egress
- Built observability across Datadog, Prisma Cloud, Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, GuardDuty, and Security Hub, with automated runbooks and structured incident response; MTTR fell 25%
- Grew and led a double-digit AWS engineering team across DACH and EMEA through hiring, onboarding, mentoring, and career frameworks that reduced attrition and built a promotion pipeline
- Defined and rolled out engineering standards (code review, IaC patterns, and documentation) adopted across all delivery teams, and led knowledge transfer on Agentic AI (Bedrock), local LLMs, and CI/CD shift-left

Senior Principal Cloud Architect | JJ Tech Inc.

Apr 2020 - Feb 2024

- Multi-Account AWS Foundations:** Designed and scaled secure multi-account AWS environments using AWS Organizations, SCPs, Control Tower, centralized logging, and cross-account IAM roles across development, staging, and production workloads
- Reusable Terraform Architecture:** Authored reusable Terraform modules for VPC, ECS, RDS, IAM, ALB, security groups, and environment baselines, cutting new environment provisioning from days to under 2 hours and improving deployment consistency
- CI/CD at Scale:** Built and operated CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub, CodePipeline, CodeBuild, and CodeDeploy; release frequency increased 40% and manual-deployment configuration drift dropped
- Network & Security Architecture:** Architected hub-and-spoke VPC topologies with Transit Gateway, custom route tables, private subnet segmentation, security groups, and IAM least-privilege controls to reduce identity and lateral-movement risk
- Disaster Recovery & Resilience:** Designed high-availability and multi-region disaster recovery architectures, automated failover testing, documented operational runbooks, and established RTO/RPO-driven recovery practices for critical workloads

- **Database & Application Operations:** Managed RDS, DynamoDB, database snapshots, read replicas, lifecycle policies, and performance tuning in collaboration with application engineering teams to improve reliability and response times
- **CloudFormation & Ansible Automation:** Developed CloudFormation stacks and Ansible playbooks for EC2 configuration, application bootstrapping, compliance baselining, patching, and repeatable environment configuration
- **Governance & Quality Controls:** Integrated security scanning, code quality, and compliance practices using Checkov, SonarQube, CloudTrail, AWS Config, and CloudWatch to improve audit readiness and enforce operational standards

AWS Cloud Consultant | The Will Group, Inc.

Feb 2019 - Mar 2020

- **Migration Delivery:** Led end-to-end AWS migration engagements for enterprise clients, producing Statements of Work, Proofs of Concept, architecture diagrams, and phased migration roadmaps that cut time-to-cloud by an average of 35% against client self-managed estimates
- **Architecture Design:** Designed target-state AWS architectures covering networking, compute, storage, IAM, monitoring, and compliance controls, translating business requirements into documented technical solutions aligned to AWS Well-Architected best practices
- **Cross-Functional Delivery:** Partnered with client security, DevOps, and development teams to harden cloud infrastructure, deliver operational runbooks, and conduct stakeholder workshops supporting post-handoff self-operation
- **Post-Deployment Support:** Provided architecture reviews, troubleshooting guidance, technical documentation, and knowledge transfer to help client teams operate and scale AWS environments independently

AWS Cloud Engineer | Olam Group

Jan 2017 - Jan 2019

- **Legacy Migration:** Migrated legacy applications from internal data centers to AWS, cutting infrastructure spend 20% while improving application availability and supporting enterprise cloud transformation initiatives
- **Secure Architecture:** Implemented private subnets, bastion hosts, NAT Gateways, Security Groups, NACLs, WAF, Shield, encryption in transit and at rest, and Route 53 routing policies for secure AWS workloads
- **CI/CD & Containers:** Developed Docker-based deployments and maintained Jenkins, GitHub, GitLab CI, and Ansible automation workflows for consistent application delivery across environments
- **Operations & Governance:** Configured CloudWatch alarms, Lambda automation, AWS Organizations governance, disaster recovery architectures, failover testing, and operational troubleshooting for cloud-hosted applications

Data Processing Clerk | Riders for Health (RFH), The Gambia

Jan 2008 - Dec 2012

- Helped turn daily operational records into accurate, organised and useful information, supporting reporting, planning and informed decision-making
- **Inaccurate or incomplete data:** Checked records for errors, missing details and inconsistencies, helping ensure information is reliable before it is used in reports
- **Scattered paperwork:** Entered and organised information from paper forms and other sources into structured electronic records, making it easier to find and update
- **Duplicate and inconsistent records:** Identified repeated entries and standardised formats to improve data quality and prevent misleading totals
- **Reporting delays:** Processed incoming records and prepared summaries on time, helping colleagues access the information they need
- **Unresolved discrepancies:** Compared entries with source documents and followed up with relevant colleagues to clarify missing or conflicting information
- **Limited visibility into daily activities:** Consolidated operational data into clear summaries that help teams monitor progress and identify gaps requiring attention
- Difficulty retrieving historical information: Maintained organised files and records to support enquiries, reporting and document reviews
- **Sensitive information handling:** Handled confidential records carefully and followed organisational procedures for data access and storage
- Focused on accuracy, attention to detail and timely processing, helping the team spend less time correcting records and more time acting on reliable information

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Cloud & Compute: AWS EC2, VPC, IAM, S3, ECS, EKS, Fargate, ECR, Lambda, RDS, Aurora, DynamoDB, API Gateway, Route 53, CloudFront, Cognito, SNS, SQS, WAF, Shield

AI & ML Services: Amazon Bedrock, Textract, Transcribe, Translate, Comprehend, Rekognition, Amazon Q, SageMaker, Kiro IDE, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Agentic AI, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Event-Driven AI Workflows

Containers & Platform: Docker, Amazon ECS, Amazon EKS, Kubernetes, Fargate, code-server, Internal Developer Platforms, Secure SSM Access, Helm

IaC & CI/CD: Terraform, Terragrunt, CloudFormation, Ansible, Makefile, Systems Manager, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, CodePipeline, CodeBuild, CodeDeploy, ECR, Nexus, SonarQube, Checkov, TFLint, Shift-Left Security Scanning, OIDC Role Assumption

Networking & Multicloud: Aviatrix Controller, Aviatrix CoPilot, ActiveMesh, SmartGroups, Distributed Cloud Firewall, Central Egress, Transit Gateway, Direct Connect, VPC Design, ALB/NLB

Security, Compliance & Observability: IAM, Cognito, KMS, Secrets Manager, ACM, Macie, Prisma Cloud, AWS Artifact, Trivy, Deepfence (Runtime/Workload Security), Checkov, TFLint, OIDC / Short-Lived Credentials, Secret Scanning, IaC Misconfiguration Scanning, Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, GuardDuty, Security Hub, AWS Config, WAF, Incident Response

Programming: Python, Go, Bash, Shell Scripting, Linux, Git

FinOps & Cost Optimization: Cloud Cost Management, Resource Optimization, AWS Cost Explorer, Azure Cost Management, Reserved Instance Planning, FinOps Practices, Right-sizing

Leadership & Soft Skills: Stakeholder Management, Executive-level Facilitation, Technical Presentations, Cross-cultural Team Leadership, Mentoring & Coaching, AWS Cloud Computing Instructor (Global Elite Computing), Agile/Scrum, Cost Optimization, AI-Assisted Delivery, Talent Development, Career Frameworks

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- AWS Certified Security - Specialty (Jun 2025)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (May 2024)
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate (Nov 2023)
- Aviatrix Multicloud Network Security Specialty (May 2025)
- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional (Apr 2025)
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner (2025)
- Aviatrix Multicloud Network Professional (Feb 2025)
- Aviatrix Multicloud Network Cloud Backbone Specialty (Apr 2025)
- Aviatrix Multicloud Network Operations Specialty (Feb 2025)
- Aviatrix Multicloud Network Associate (Feb 2025)
- Artificial Intelligence and Business Strategy (Mar 2024)
- Generative AI for Business Leaders (Mar 2024)
- Responsive Web Design (2023)
- AI-Ready: Foundational (Nov 2024)
- AI-Ready: Practitioner (Apr 2024)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering, University of The Gambia, Banjul | 2009 - 2013

Diploma in Software Application, Microtech Institute of Technology | 2012

Diploma in Information Technology & Hardware, QuantumNet Institute of Technology | 2011 - 2012

LANGUAGES

English Fluent · German C1